

## MOTHERBOARDS (INTEL)

This year saw the arrival of 2GHz processors from Intel along with a slew of supporting chipsets. The 400 MHz FSB speed introduced with the Pentium 4 witnessed the opportunity to greatly increase bandwidth between the processor, system memory and chipset. Incorporating support for the newest protocols such as DDR and RDRAM memory have driven board performance levels to new highs.

Be on the watch for marked improvements in memory support speeds, particularly those for an upcoming technology called Quad-Rate DRAM which pumps out data four times per clock cycle. A new iteration of the PCI bus, PCI-X provides over 1GBps of bandwidth. In the future, Intel's Third Generation I/O interconnect will see bus speeds shoot through the roof. With increasingly higher levels of component integration on motherboards, performance numbers are sure to go up. Needless to say, new CPUs from Intel will be the driving force for better and faster motherboards in the future.



ASUS P4T

*Outstanding performance, rock solid stability and excellent build quality make this board the choice for Pentium 4 based systems*

Its great features and excellent build quality bundled with the capability of being over clocked makes it overtake the rest of the competition very easily. The construction and the attention to detail also make this board a very good choice, providing for effortless system construction. With very stable performance in all the tests, this board provides the ideal platform for your Socket 423 Pentium 4 processor.

- + Highly overclockable and very stable
- + Comes with 16 multiplier settings
- Price:** Not available
- Contact:** Rashi Peripherals

**Phone:** 022-8260256-59  
**Fax:** 022-8221012  
**E-mail:** ho@rptechindia.com  
**Reviewed in:** March 2001

### Worthy Mentions

#### AOpen AX4T

- + Plenty of system monitoring functionality built into the board
- + Very good construction and layout of the board make for easy processor installation
- Price:** Rs 9,250
- Contact:** Yogi Comp
- Phone:** 022-8806582
- Fax:** 022-8806582
- E-mail:** yogicomp@netcracker.com
- Reviewed in:** September 2001

#### Intel Tehama D850GB

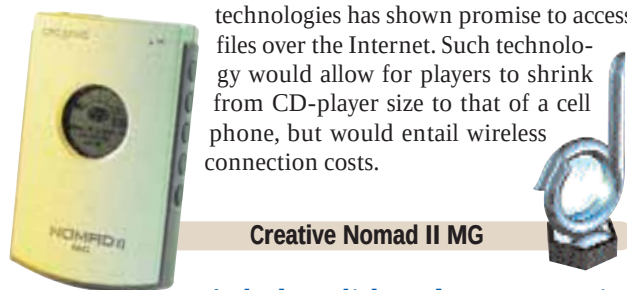
- + Very stable performance
- + Roomy layout of system components
- Price:** Rs 10,500
- Contact:** Nebula Technologies
- Phone:** 022-6347158/9
- Fax:** 022-6347156
- E-mail:** sandip@nebulatech.com
- Reviewed in:** March 2001

**PREVIOUS WINNERS** 2000: ASUS CUV4X 1999: NA 1998: NA

## MP3 PLAYERS

Early MP3 players based upon Flash memory were not only expensive, but also didn't have the space to store a good amount of songs. Though memory became cheaper, new ways of playing back MP3 songs were devised. CD-based players offered not only a lower-cost MP3 solution, they also provided for many times the amount of storage space. Things got even better when a hard disk was substituted for Flash memory. The result? Gigabytes of your favourite tunes at your fingertips.

As the footprint for higher storage capacities continues to diminish, we can look forward to gigabytes of song data that fits into your pocket. With added support for standards such as MP3Pro and Ogg Vorbis, you will be able to store even more data for an endless array of music. Beyond this, the use of wireless technologies has shown promise to access files over the Internet. Such technology would allow for players to shrink from CD-player size to that of a cell phone, but would entail wireless connection costs.



Creative Nomad II MG

*A sleek, stylish and compact unit with skip-free music playback, which can be upgraded to add more playtime*

This cool baby is the sleek and suave power accessory for those who are happier with small and feature-filled packages that suit their style. Great build quality, a nice interface, good audio transfer speeds, support for WMA format and a very utilitarian software bundle is what makes this MP3 player stand out from the rest of the pack.

- + Impeccable build quality
- + Good looks, features and bundled software
- Price:** Rs 19,110
- Contact:** Compuage Infocom Ltd

**Phone:** 022-8305500  
**Fax:** 022-8238619  
**E-mail:** info@compuageindia.com  
**Reviewed in:** August 2001

### Worthy Mentions

#### Creative Nomad Jukebox

- + Mammoth 6 GB storage capacity
- + Replete with features (quad channel outputs, EAX)
- Price:** Rs 23,400
- Contact:** Compuage Infocom Ltd
- Phone:** 022-8305501/02/03
- Fax:** 022-8238619
- E-mail:** info@compuageindia.com
- Reviewed in:** August 2001

#### Philips eXpanium

- + Great value for money
- + Very portable, plenty of storage capacity
- Price:** Rs 12,990
- Contact:** Philips India Ltd
- Phone:** 022-6912333
- Fax:** 022-8259276
- Reviewed in:** August 2001

**PREVIOUS WINNERS** 2000: Creative Nomad II 1999: NA 1998: NA